

AI Prompt Building for HR Managers

A Practical Guide to Getting Better Results from AI Tools

AI tools like ChatGPT, Claude, and Copilot can save HR teams hours each week — but only if you know how to communicate with them effectively. The difference between a vague prompt and a structured one is the difference between generic filler and a usable first draft.

This guide gives you a repeatable framework and real HR examples you can use immediately.

The CRAFT Framework

- C — Context:** Who are you? What's the situation?
- R — Role:** Who should the AI act as?
- A — Action:** What exactly do you want it to do?
- F — Format:** How should the output be structured?
- T — Tone:** What voice or style should it use?

Before & After: See the Difference

Weak Prompt:

EXAMPLE — WEAK

Write me a job description for a marketing person.

Strong Prompt (using CRAFT):

EXAMPLE — STRONG

Context: I'm an HR Manager at a 200-person SaaS company hiring for our first dedicated marketing role. Role: Act as a senior HR copywriter with tech industry experience. Action: Write a job description for a Marketing Manager. Include responsibilities, qualifications (must-have vs. nice-to-have), and a compelling company culture section. Format: Use headers, bullet points, and keep it under 600 words. Tone: Professional but approachable — we're a startup, not a bank.

Pro Tip: You can always follow up with "Make it shorter," "Add a DEI statement," or "Make the tone more formal."

Ready-to-Use HR Prompt Templates

1. Policy Drafting

TEMPLATE

Context: Our 150-employee company has no formal remote work policy. Role: Act as an HR policy specialist. Action: Draft a remote/hybrid work policy covering eligibility, expectations, equipment, and communication norms. Format: Numbered sections with headers. Tone: Clear and firm but employee-friendly.

2. Interview Questions

TEMPLATE

Context: I'm interviewing candidates for a Senior Accountant role. Role: Act as a behavioral interview expert. Action: Generate 8 interview questions — 4 behavioral, 2 situational, 2 technical. Format: Numbered list with a brief note on what each question evaluates. Tone: Conversational but structured.

3. Employee Communication

TEMPLATE

Context: We're switching health insurance providers effective next quarter. Role: Act as an internal communications specialist. Action: Write an employee announcement email explaining the change, what stays the same, what's new, and next steps. Format: Short paragraphs with a bullet-point summary of key changes. Tone: Reassuring and transparent.

4. Performance Review Assistance

TEMPLATE

Context: I need to write a constructive performance review for an employee who exceeds technical goals but struggles with collaboration. Role: Act as a seasoned HR business partner. Action: Write a balanced performance review summary with strengths, growth areas, and 2–3 specific development goals. Format: Three sections — Strengths, Areas for Growth, Goals. Tone: Supportive, specific, and development-focused.

Five Rules for Better AI Prompts

- Be specific — vague input equals vague output. Include numbers, names, and constraints.
- Assign a role — telling AI “who to be” dramatically improves quality.
- Iterate — your first prompt is a starting point. Refine with follow-ups.
- Protect sensitive data — never paste employee SSNs, salaries, or PII into AI tools.
- Verify everything — AI can be confidently wrong. Always review before using.

Want help building AI workflows for your HR team?

Book a free automation audit at www.ebygautomation.com | info@ebygautomation.com